PROJECT REPORT OF DIGITAL LITERACY

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Introduction

As a newly selected Student Digital Ambassador at my college, I have been entrusted with the responsibility of guiding my peers in navigating the digital world effectively and responsibly. In today's technology-driven environment, students must not only use digital tools but also understand how to do so safely, ethically, and professionally. My first assignment is to develop a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio that addresses key areas such as creating professional online profiles, maintaining a positive digital footprint, practicing safe internet habits, and following proper online communication etiquette.

This portfolio will include practical guidelines, real-life examples, and useful digital tools that students can easily adopt in their academic and personal lives. It will also emphasize cybersecurity awareness, privacy protection, and responsible social media use. The final portfolio will be presented to the faculty committee and shared with my batch to promote awareness and encourage informed, safe, and professional digital engagement among students.

Task - 1 Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I used the Canva platform to create a one-page infographic on Digital Literacy. Canva was chosen because of its user-friendly interface, ready-made templates, and wide range of icons and design elements that made the process efficient and visually appealing.

My design is divided into three clear sections. The first section explains **what digital literacy is**, highlighting the ability to use digital tools effectively, safely, and responsibly. The second section focuses on **useful digital tools for students**, such as online collaboration platforms, note-taking apps, and cloud storage services that support academic work. The third section presents **safe internet practices**, including using strong passwords, avoiding suspicious links, protecting personal information, and enabling two-factor authentication.

I used simple icons, minimal text, and a clean layout to ensure the infographic is easy to understand at a glance. One interesting aspect of this task was experimenting with different color combinations and layouts to make the content engaging. However, I found it slightly challenging to fit all the important information into a single page while keeping the design neat and not overcrowded.

Task - 2 Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I created professional profiles on **LinkedIn**, **GitHub**, and **ResearchGate** to build a strong digital presence. On LinkedIn, I completed my Education section by adding my B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering, my college name, and my expected graduation year. This platform is mainly used for professional networking, showcasing achievements, and connecting with recruiters and industry experts.

GitHub is a platform focused on version control and open-source collaboration, where users can host code, manage projects, and improve their development skills. I plan to use it to build practical projects and strengthen my software-related knowledge. **ResearchGate** is a professional network for scientists and researchers, which helps in accessing academic papers and learning from a global scholarly community.

Over the next four years, I plan to actively update my LinkedIn profile with projects, internships, and certifications. I will use GitHub to enhance my technical skills and contribute to repositories, while ResearchGate will help me learn advanced research techniques and stay updated with emerging technologies as my academic knowledge grows.

Task - 3 Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For this task, I used HackerRank for coding practice and Google Workspace for creating a digital quiz. On HackerRank, I completed a beginner-level challenge ("Solve Me First"), which helped me understand basic problem-solving and coding structure. It was a good starting point to build confidence in programming and improve logical thinking.

For collaboration, I used Google Forms (a tool within Google Workspace) to create a **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz** with exactly five questions, including both multiple-choice and short-answer types. I also linked the responses to Google Sheets, which allows automatic data collection and analysis. This makes it easy to review answers and understand common knowledge gaps among students.

These tools will be very helpful academically. HackerRank will strengthen my coding skills through regular practice, which is essential for exams, projects, and placements. Google Workspace tools will help me collaborate efficiently with classmates, conduct surveys, and organize data. Together, these platforms enhance both technical skills and teamwork, which are important for academic success and future career growth.

Task - 4 Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

A common situation where poor digital communication caused problems is when a student sends an email to a professor without a subject line, proper greeting, or clear message. For example, sending a message like “Send marks fast” can be seen as rude and unprofessional. This may lead to misunderstandings, delayed responses, or even a negative impression on the professor.

This issue could have been avoided by following proper email etiquette. The student should include a clear subject line, use a respectful greeting, and clearly explain their request in a polite manner. Adding a proper sign-off also shows professionalism. Effective digital communication helps build respect, avoids confusion, and ensures that the message is taken seriously.

Task - 5 Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

While researching phishing scams, I was surprised by how realistic fake emails and websites can appear. Attackers use official logos, similar URLs, and urgent language to create a sense of trust and panic, making it easy for users to fall into the trap. I also learned that even a small mistake, like clicking on a single link, can lead to serious consequences such as data theft or financial loss.

As a result, one habit I will personally change is carefully checking every link and sender before taking any action online. I will avoid rushing into decisions based on urgency and always verify the authenticity of messages. This awareness will help me stay safer online and also guide my peers to be more cautious.

Conclusion

This Digital Literacy Portfolio highlights the importance of developing essential digital skills for academic and professional success. Through tasks such as creating professional profiles, practicing coding, designing infographics, and writing formal emails, I have gained practical knowledge of using digital tools effectively. The project also emphasized responsible online behavior, including social media etiquette, safe communication, and awareness of cyber threats like phishing.

By exploring platforms like LinkedIn, HackerRank, and collaborative tools like Google Workspace, I have strengthened both my technical and communication skills. Additionally,

learning about online safety measures and reporting channels has made me more cautious and responsible in digital spaces.

Overall, this project has prepared me to guide my peers as a Student Digital Ambassador, helping them build a strong digital presence, communicate professionally, and stay safe online in an increasingly digital world.

References

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